

AKSHAY DHAR

AI Product Manager | Fintech and Sustainability

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Consultant

Apr 2026 – Sep 2026

Catalysk, AI Sustainability Analytics

Bengaluru, India

- **Architected and led the build** of the multi-stage categorization engine with a small team — rule and keyword matching, merchant extraction, an SBERT semantic fallback, and the evaluation harness — owning it from design through production and iterating on it release over release.
- **Cut** uncategorized transactions from 39% to 13% by redesigning VPA and P2P categorization logic feeding client ESG reporting.
- **Lifted** category accuracy 5 points by running an embedding model bake-off (MiniLM, E5, BGE) against a golden set, rejecting a slower model that only looked better on paper.
- **Reduced** processing from hours to minutes per 1,000 rows by removing per-row regex recompilation and redundant set rebuilds and adding embedding caching, with zero change to categorization output.
- **Grew** model coverage from 21 to 36 categories and 10K to 17K training examples by retraining the SBERT model, merging a second tenant taxonomy with zero golden-set regression.
- **Gated** auto-categorization at ~84% model confidence, abstaining on uncertain rows to prioritise precision over vanity coverage.
- **Defined** the release bar with a 388-row UAT golden set and a 1,400-row benchmark across 7 bank statements, gating every model and taxonomy change.
- **Recovered** a catch-all bucket that had swelled to ~30% of volume by diagnosing a silent regression that disabled the SBERT model and 4 downstream stages without raising an error.
- **Shipped** 90+ automated data quality checks across 5 financial schemas in 6 phases, catching silent bad data before it reached the model.
- **Cut** new banking partner onboarding from days to hours with a config-driven YAML framework and one ingestion contract for CSV, Excel, JSON and REST, so analysts change rules without engineering.
- **Launched** an 18-table PostgreSQL observability layer, replacing manual Excel review with live Metabase dashboards for non-engineers.

Senior Data Associate

Jan 2025 – Sep 2025

9FIN, Institutional Financial Technology Platform

Belfast, UK

- **Delivered** £390K annual cost savings and 32% faster client delivery by owning a production ML market-news crawler, resolving incidents and adding verification controls.
- **Accelerated** client onboarding by 15% by shipping the Gemini API into production automation for post-acquisition schema alignment.
- **Mentored** 15 analysts on data quality standards, verification workflows and tooling, raising consistency across the data team.

Data Associate

May 2024 – Dec 2024

9FIN, Institutional Financial Technology Platform

Belfast, UK

- **Maintained** 100% data accuracy against delivery SLAs across 140+ institutional credit accounts.
- **Built** real-time KPI and incident dashboards across 2 platforms (Power BI, Notion), informing product, engineering and non-technical stakeholders.

Data Science Intern

Jun 2023 – Sep 2023

Jambird Marketing

Belfast, UK

- **Deployed** an NLP text classification model at 87% accuracy that automated insight generation and replaced a manual review process.
- **Engineered** features across 3M+ data points and presented the findings to senior stakeholders as an actionable marketing strategy.

SELECTED PROJECTS

End-to-End Stock Price Forecasting Pipeline *Personal Project*

Feb 2026 – Mar 2026

- **Built** a production-grade pipeline taking live market data via API into PostgreSQL, with ARIMA and LSTM multi-step forecasting and serialized models for reuse.

EV Customer Demand Segmentation *Energia Group*

2023

- **Segmented** 180K customers into 6 high-value cohorts with K-means clustering, with Power BI dashboards informing EV investment.

Electricity Market Price Forecasting *Energia Group*

2023

- **Delivered** a 3-model forecasting system (VAR, STL, Random Forest) for trading decisions, surfaced through executive Tableau dashboards.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

MSc Data Analytics *Queen's University Belfast, UK*

2022 – 2023

BSc Computer Science *Assam University Silchar, India*

2017 – 2020

Oracle Cloud Infrastructure AI Foundations Associate | BCG GenAI Job Simulation (Forage) | Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate